

The Dhāraṇī Called 'That Which Increases Wisdom'

Prajñāvardhanī nāma dhāraṇī · Toh 650 · Derge Kangyur

པར་ཀླ་པའི་གཙུག་པོའི་

The dhāraṇī called "That Which Increases Wisdom," known in Sanskrit as the Prajñāvardhanī nāma dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Shes rab 'phel bar byed pa zhes bya ba'i gzungs, is a short ritual dhāraṇī text focused on the cultivation and enhancement of wisdom and mental retention. It belongs to the dhāraṇī genre of Buddhist literature, presenting a sacred mantra together with practical instructions for its use — in this case, reciting the mantra over barley gruel and drinking it daily for a month in order to purify misdeeds, remove obscurations, and increase one's capacity to retain teachings. The text opens with homage to the Three Jewels and to the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, situating it within the broader tradition of compassion-oriented Mahāyāna practice. It is Toh 650 in the Kangyur, belonging to the general class of dhāraṇī and mantra literature.

All those who dwell in water and so forth, and whoever drinks that water, will have all their misdeeds and obscurations purified and will come to travel the path of happy destinies. The heart of the Wisdom Star dhāraṇī is complete.

In the language of India: Prajñāvardhanī nāma dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The dhāraṇī called "That Which Increases Wisdom."

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the noble Avalokiteśvara, bodhisattva, great being, one of great compassion.

Thus: Oṃ biba biba, prajñāvarddhani, jara jara, medhāvarddhani, dhiri dhiri, buddhivarddhani svāhā.

The ritual practice of this mantra is as follows. Each morning, recite it twenty-one times over a full cup of fresh barley gruel, and drink it continually for the span of one month. By doing so, one will come to retain what one has heard.

The dhāraṇī called "That Which Increases Wisdom" is complete.

The Indian paṇḍita Jñānagarbha and the translator Bandhe —

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, cutting off the translator's name and colophon. This is a manuscript boundary, not a translation choice.

The phrase rendered "fresh barley gruel" translates *rtsab mo khyor gang*, literally "a full cup of coarse gruel" — *rtsab mo* indicating a thick or coarse grain drink, likely barley-based as was standard in Tibetan medicinal-ritual contexts.

The preceding section closes the "Heart of the Wisdom Star" *dhāraṇī*, and the passage then opens a new text, the *Prajñāvardhanī dhāraṇī*, with its own Sanskrit title, salutation, mantra, and ritual instructions. These are two distinct texts joined here in the manuscript.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.